

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ***** WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 59 WSJ.com ★★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 52786.07 ▼ 628.18 1.18% NASDAQ 26421.41 ▼ 0.3% STOXX 600 649.60 ▼ 0.05% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 6/32, yield 4.805% OIL \$93.03 ▲ \$1.55 GOLD \$4,393.90 ▼ \$35.90 EURO \$1.1626 YEN 154.00

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Oil-sensitive stocks** took a hit before recovering some ground as Brent fell off the day's highs to close at \$97.92 a barrel. Indexes fell, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq shedding 0.6%, 1.2% and 0.3%, respectively. **A1**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms** unveiled a new personal AI agent that can buy goods online, respond to emails and complete other tasks users authorize it to do for them. **B1**
- ◆ **Robinhood** will add Crypto.com's yes-or-no contracts to its trading platform and take minority stakes in the digital-currency exchange and its prediction-markets business. **B1**
- ◆ **GameStop** reported higher profit in its latest quarter, boosted by an increase in collectibles sales, and raised its full-year outlook. **B3**
- ◆ **Verizon and Corning** reached a multibillion-dollar agreement to deploy more than 80 million miles of high-density optical fiber across the U.S. over the next five years. **B4**
- ◆ **The U.S. government** will take minority equity stakes in D-Wave, Rigetti and Quantinuum in a combined \$300 million deal to underwrite their quantum-computing research. **B4**
- ◆ **AstraZeneca** said its new drug for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease showed benefits across a broad patient population in late-stage clinical trials, boosting a medicine the company expects to generate multibillion-dollar sales. **B5**
- ◆ **Boston Scientific** said it likely won't meet its financial guidance due to the cyberattack that has disrupted its operations. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The U.S. destroyed** five Iranian oil tankers in response to recent attempts by Tehran to strike U.S. warships in the Middle East, Central Command said. **A8**
- ◆ **Iran-backed Houthi** militants in Yemen fired drones and missiles at several Saudi energy facilities. **A8**
- ◆ **The U.K., France,** Canada and nine other countries said they would impose new trade restrictions on Israel over the expansion of Israeli settlements in the West Bank. **A1**
- ◆ **Some state lawmakers** want to repeal sales-tax exemptions formerly granted to tech companies for data-center gear and renegotiate deals. **A1**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** appealed to the Supreme Court for its blessing to deploy an immigration database it says could be used to identify people improperly registered to vote. **A3**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** declined to let Missouri use a congressional map in the midterms that the state GOP redrew to benefit Republicans, while a federal judge in another case issued a temporary order restoring the map. **A6**
- ◆ **Trump signed orders** to ban the importation of many dairy products, alcoholic beverages and motorcycles from Canada in three weeks. **A2**
- ◆ **Two systems** that could have slowed an Amazon Air flight that crashed in Miami weren't deployed before the plane careened off the runway and into nearby vehicles, investigators said. **A6**
- ◆ **Smithsonian Secretary** Lonnie Bunch III resigned. **A3**
- ◆ **New York City** officials released records related to air quality and health issues in the aftermath of the 9/11 terrorist attacks. **A3**

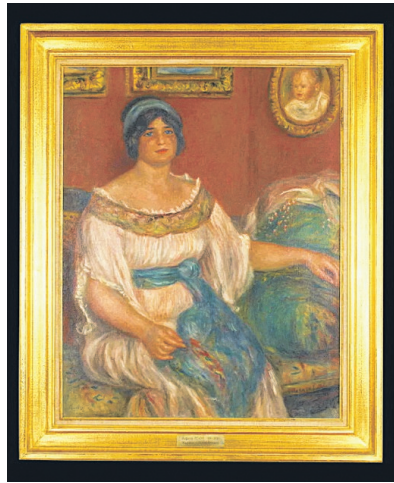
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Thieves Loot Renoirs From French Museum



CLOCCWISE: CYRIL DODERGEN/MAKAPPIZUMA PRESS; MUSEE RENOIR/REUTERS (2)



HEIST: Four paintings were stolen Tuesday from the Renoir Museum on the Riviera. 'Young Woman at the Well,' top, and 'Madame Colonna Romano,' above, are still missing. The bandits left two others behind. **A9**

Oil Nears \$100, Threatens Stocks' Long Run

Major indexes drop and benchmark Treasury yield is highest since 2023

By JACK PITCHER
AND REBECCA FENG

Oil soared above \$99 a barrel on Tuesday before retreating, marking its highest level since July and making it increasingly difficult for investors to move on from the U.S.'s continuing war with Iran.

Brent crude, the international oil benchmark, is up around 35% from this summer's lows.

Oil's rebound toward the year's highs is already showing up in domestic gasoline prices. That has hit consumer discretionary stocks sharply over the past month as well as industrial companies which count oil as a key input cost.

The expected impact on inflation has also sent Treasury yields higher, another challenge for stocks. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to 4.805% Tuesday, its highest closing level since October 2023.

Yields, which rise when bond prices fall, impact borrowing costs for companies and can make riskier assets like stocks look less attractive when they are elevated.

"Progress on inflation is poised to reverse if geopolitical tensions don't simmer," said José Torres, senior economist at Interactive Brokers.

Oil-sensitive stocks took a hit Tuesday before recovering some ground as Brent fell off the day's highs to close at \$97.92 a barrel.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average shed 1.2%, or about 628 points, dragged down by Amgen. The biotechnology

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- ◆ **Yemeni rebels hit facilities** in Saudi Arabia..... **A8**
- ◆ **U.S. strikes Iran tankers** after Navy ships targeted..... **A8**

Economic Data Show Growth, But Consumers Are Still Glum

Market strength, low unemployment fail to lift a sour mood as costs keep rising

By JUSTIN LAHART

The U.S. added an impressive 162,000 jobs last month. The unemployment rate is low. The stock market and artificial intelligence are making many people rich and boosting retirement savings.

Yet surveys tell us Americans are still in a funk.

Their sour mood doesn't match up with what major indicators say about how the U.S. economy is performing.

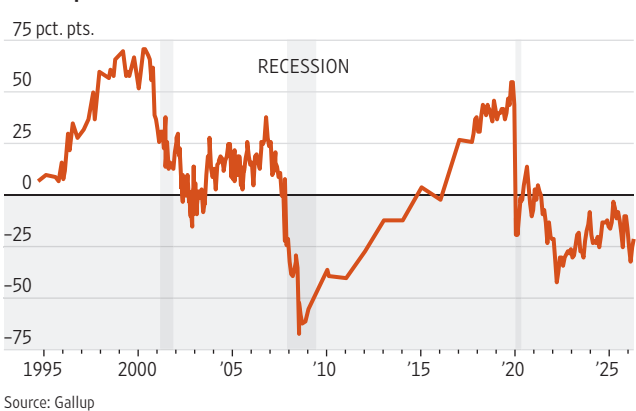
That might not mean that people are lying to themselves about their experience of the economy. Instead, broad measures might be missing how much Americans' costs have risen since the pandemic, and how many of them haven't kept up.

"People aren't wrong," University of Chicago economist Erik Hurst said.

The University of Michigan

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Share of people who rate economy as 'good' or 'excellent' minus 'poor'



Source: Gallup

European Nations Set Trade Bans Over the West Bank

By LAURENCE NORMAN
AND ANAT PELED

The U.K., France, Canada and nine other countries said they would impose new trade restrictions on Israel, escalating a dispute over the expansion of Israeli settlements in the West Bank.

Tuesday's move prompted a swift retaliation from Israel against the U.K., which was the first to announce it would halt trade with settlements in the Israeli-occupied West Bank. Israel said it would close the British consulate in East Jerusalem, which deals largely with Palestinian affairs, and expel British representatives from the U.S.-led coordination center for postwar Gaza.

U.K. Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said Tuesday that the expansion of Israeli settlements was "ethnic cleansing" that was undermining the two-state solution to peace between the Israelis and the Palestinians. The sanctions, he said, would affect direct trade with the settlements, as well as the British companies that provided services to them.

"The sanctions regime will target illegal settlements and settlement expansion, not Israel. We will continue to support Israel's right to self-defense. Please turn to page A8

INSIDE



PEDRO SALADOLIV GOLF VIA AP

BUSINESS & FINANCE
LIV Golf files for bankruptcy—and owes its star golfers millions. **B1**

Chasing Side Deals, Flexing Influence: Lewandowski at DHS

Noem's close adviser effectively controlled billions in spending; Lewandowski denies seeking business or playing role in contracts

When Corey Lewandowski was at the Department of Homeland Security, he approached senior Qatari officials with a proposal. Hire me on the side, the longtime Trump

By Tarini Parti, Josh Dawsey,
Michelle Hackman and Summer Said

aide who was effectively the shadow secretary at the department last year, told them, according to people familiar with his pitch. He said he

could help the tiny, wealthy Gulf state with any issues that fell under the department's purview, such as visas, the people said.

He approached representatives of the United Arab Emirates with a similar offer, people familiar with the outreach said.

Some of the foreigners were taken aback and confused why they would need Lewandowski's help when they already had traditional relationships with top administration of-

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She Achieved Worldwide Fame From Inside a Cave in Santorini

* * *

Customers who visit Greek artisan's shop walk away determined to make her famous

By AKIKO MATSUDA

SANTORINI, Greece—John Volkoff spent a half-hour inside a cave here in July, with his head tilted under the ceiling and the temperature rising because his 6-foot-3 frame was blocking the air conditioner.

The Oregon resident and his family were shopping during a cruise stop and Google Maps led them to an old storage space under this island's famous blue-domed church, Agios Nikolaos. The 43-square-

foot cavern was filled with colorful leather bags made by a local artisan named Iota Zaggle.

"It was hot, but that was definitely the highlight of the trip," said Volkoff, who left with a lap-top bag, a purse for his wife, and free leather keychains for his teenage daughters. "I wanted to stay there all day and talk to her more."

What Volkoff didn't know was that he was in the presence of a global celebrity.

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Leather bag lady

Data-Center Tax Breaks Get Heave-Ho in States

More than a decade ago, Ohio lawmakers exempted tech companies from sales taxes on computer servers and other equipment needed for data centers, betting that changes worth millions of dollars would lure much-needed investment to the state.

By Amrith Ramkumar,
Richard Rubin
and Neil Mehta

It worked, turning Ohio into one of the leading destinations for data centers. But then the artificial-intelligence boom supersized the tax exemption, pushing it to more than \$1.5 billion last year, more than 10 times the original state estimate. Voter out-

rage after news outlet Signal Ohio reported the scale of the provision prompted Gov. Mike DeWine, a Republican, to pause new applications for the sales tax exemption in May.

Now, some state lawmakers, including Rep. Tristan Rader, a Democrat, want to repeal the sales tax exemption and renegotiate past deals with companies like Amazon.com, Meta Platforms and Google that secured exemptions for decades by signing contracts with the state. In several states, exemptions for tech giants have exceeded \$1 billion annually.

"They seem to have more money than God, and they're able to build without the need for these types of incentives,"

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